$ neuro-landscape --snapshot 2026-10

A biased snapshot of neuro-inspired companies

119 organisations, 8 trends, and where the money, the excitement and the jobs are in October 2026

Giorgio Marinato · BraiNets Day

20 Oct 2026 · ~25 min

// 01 · the question

Where can computational neuroscience skills build a career outside academia? Which of those bets will still exist in five years?

who is there

established labs, startups, university spin-offs

what runs hot

excitement against money

what lasts

longevity, health impact, economic and ecological sustainability

// 02 · method

How the map was built

The brief

· About 100 organisations, worldwide with a Europe zoom, as of October 2026

· Three tiers: big companies' neuro programmes, startups, university spin-offs

· My four starting trends; four more added only where the data showed them

· In scope: anything that measures, decodes, stimulates or models brain or behaviour, or computes like a brain

The process

1 One search per area, plus one for gaps (China, EEG/MEG makers, Marseille): 152 candidates

2 Duplicates merged, thin or off-topic ones dropped: 119 kept

3 35 headline facts re-checked at the source: 24 right, 11 fixed, 0 wrong

4 Each organisation scored 1–5 on five separate dimensions, with a written reason

No hierarchy in the scores. Ecological is scored only for the 27 organisations where energy or compute matters.

Result: 119 organisations, 87 investment rounds, 122 news items from 2025–26, each with a source. Limits: only announced money; scores are judgement, not measurement; Europe over-represented on purpose.

// 03 · the landscape

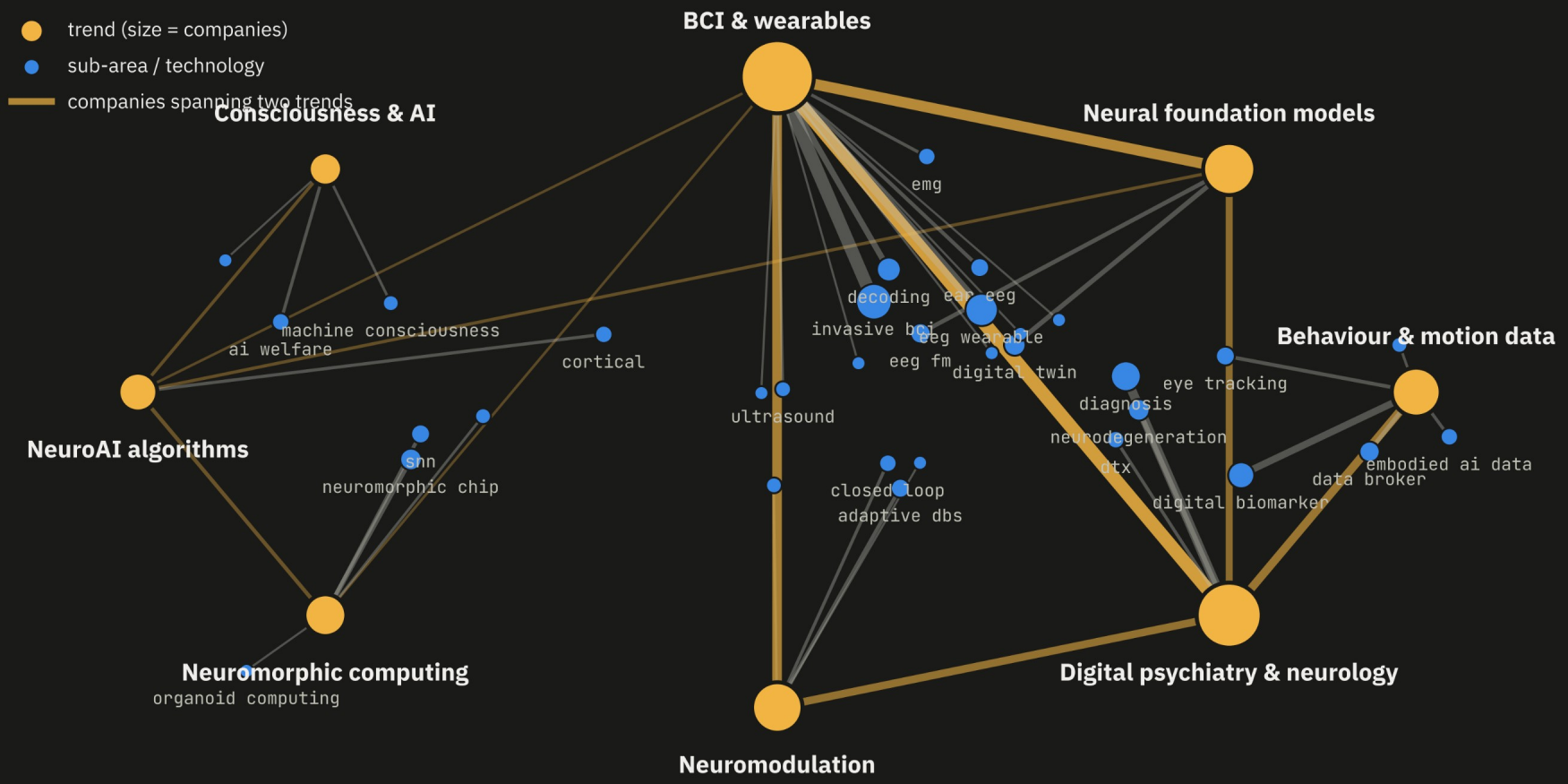
119 organisations in three tiers and eight trends

Trend	Established	Spin-off	Startup	Total	Examples
BCI & wearables	4	10	26	40	Neuralink, Synchron, INBRAIN
Digital psychiatry & neurology	2	4	11	17	Ceribell, Beacon, Brainomix
Neuromodulation	7	2	6	15	Medtronic, ONWARD, Flow
Behaviour & motion data	5	0	9	14	Smart Eye, Mecka, Noldus
Neural foundation models	5	0	6	11	Meta FAIR, Hemispheric, Piramidal
Neuromorphic computing	3	5	3	11	Intel Labs, SynSense, Cortical Labs
Consciousness & AI	1	1	4	6	Anthropic, Eleos, Astera
NeuroAI algorithms	1	2	2	5	DeepMind, Liquid AI, Opteran
All	**28**	**24**	**67**	**119**	**7 closed or acquired since 2023**

Highlighted on click: the four trends I was most interested in · primary trend per organisation · 04/24

// 04 · knowledge graph

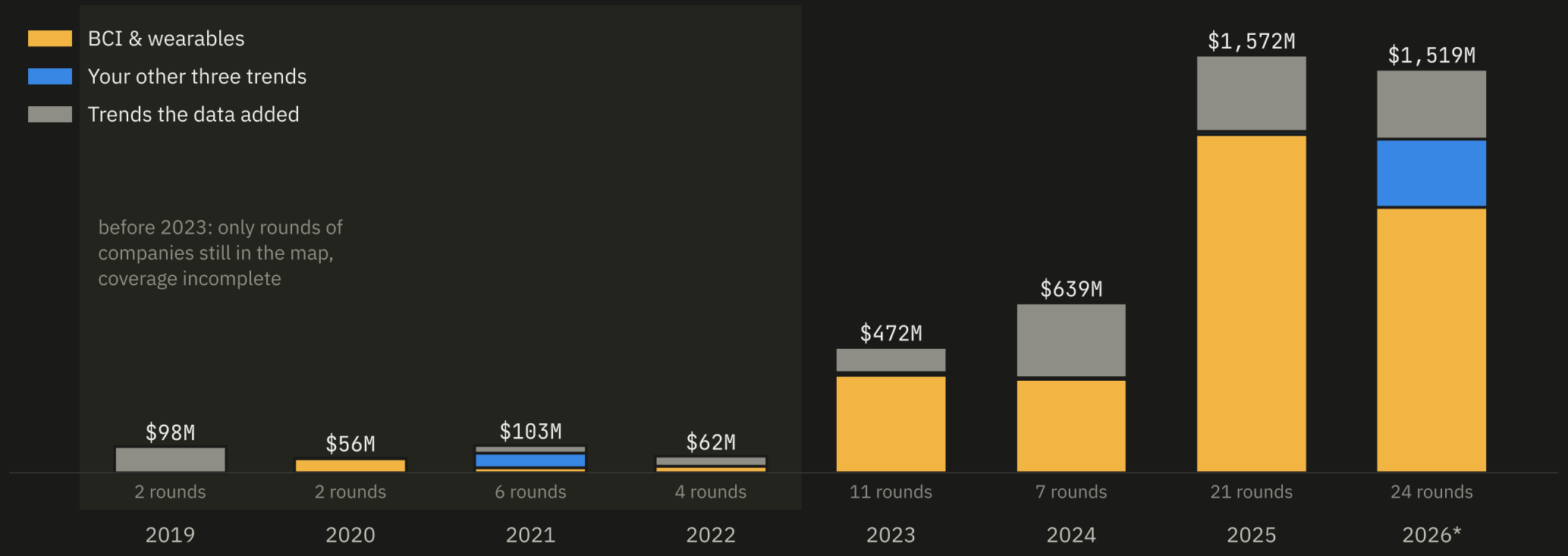
BCI, stimulation, brain models, clinic



Built from company trend tags and sub-areas · edge width = companies spanning both · 05/24

// 05 · where the money goes

Funding tripled since 2023, and BCI takes 71%



Disclosed rounds of startups and spin-offs · 2026 up to 15 Oct · before 2023 incomplete · 06/24

// 06 · who gets it, and where

Ten rounds hold two thirds of the money; Europe gets 6%

80%

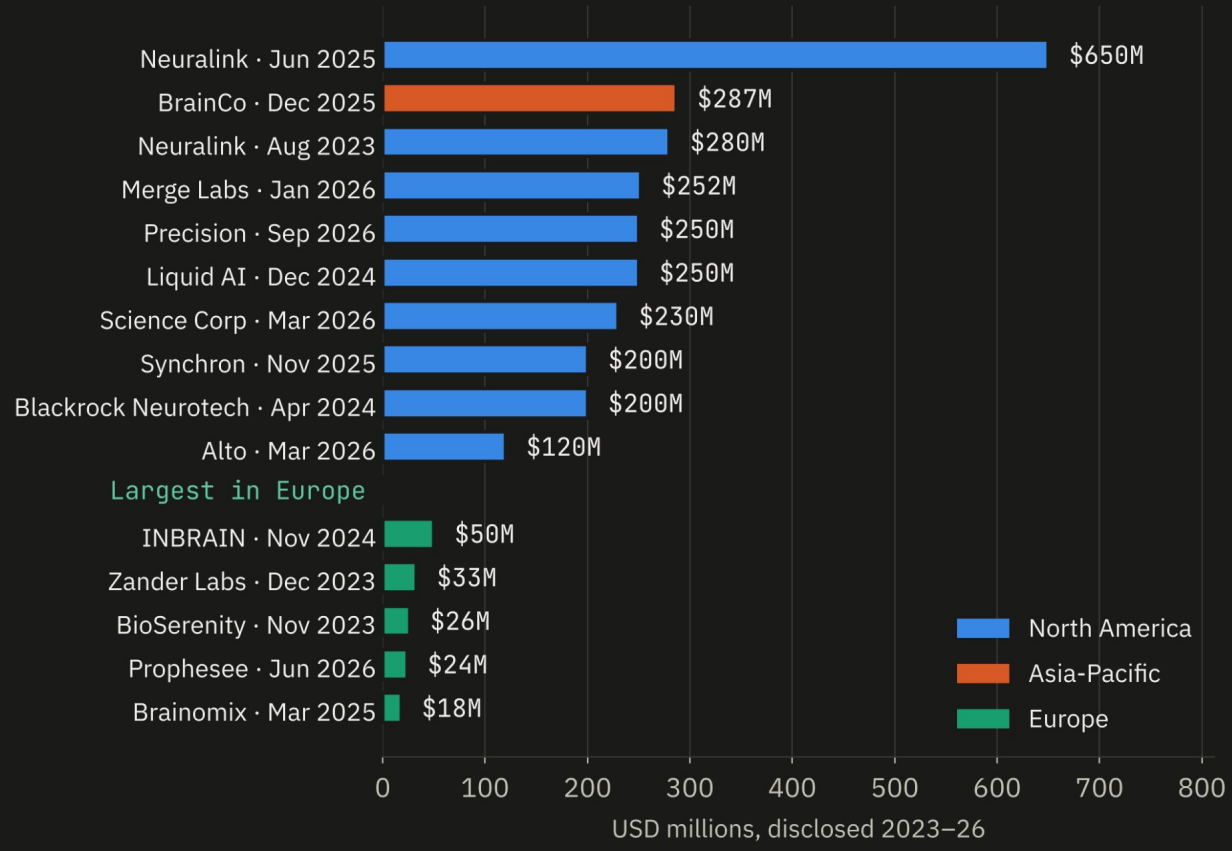
North America · $3.38B

12%

Asia-Pacific · $0.52B, mostly Chinese BCI

6%

Europe · $0.27B, from 39% of the organisations mapped

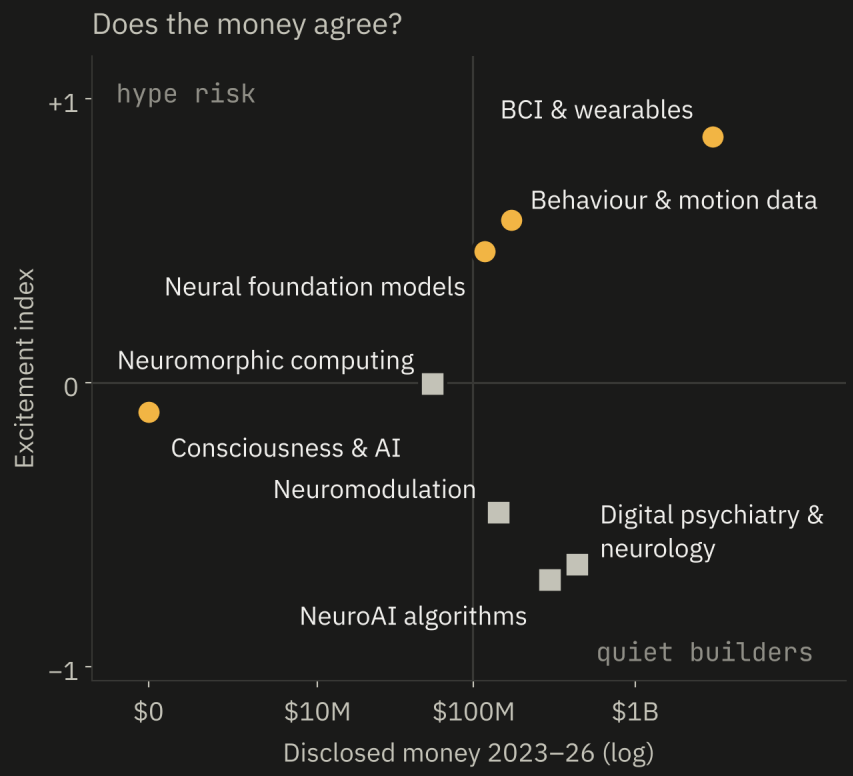


Disclosed rounds 2023–26 · BrainCo figure reported, converted from CNY · 07/24

// 07 · temperature

Excitement vs money: only BCI is hot and funded

	Funding momentum	New companies	Online buzz	Specialist news	Paper growth	Index
BCI & wearables	+0.2	+2.3	+0.5	+1.9	-0.6	
Behaviour & motion data	+1.0	+0.5	+0.5	+0.3	+0.5	
Neural foundation models	+1.2	-0.3	-1.0	+0.0	+2.5	
Neuromorphic computing	+0.1	-0.3	+0.2	+0.0	-0.0	
Consciousness & AI	-0.1	+0.1	+1.3	-1.2	-0.6	
Neuromodulation	-1.4	-0.8	-0.2	+0.5	-0.4	
Digital psychiatry & neurology	+0.8	-1.2	-2.1	+0.2	-0.9	
NeuroAI algorithms	-1.7	-0.3	+0.7	-1.6	-0.5	

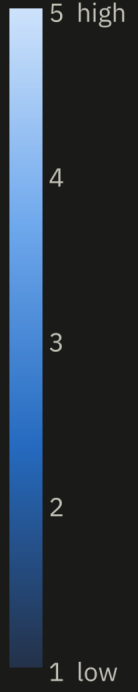


Left: each signal relative to the average trend (red above, blue below) · right: index vs money · 08/24

// 08 · fields scorecard

Neuromodulation longevity and health impact: the companies are established medical-device makers

	Longevity	Disruption	Health	Economic sustain.	Ecological sustain.
BCI & wearables	3.2	3.4	2.7	2.4	2.0*
Neural foundation models	3.3	3.6	2.1	2.5	2.4
Behaviour & motion data	3.0	2.9	2.0	2.8	2.0*
Consciousness & AI	2.8	3.2	1.7	2.0	n/a
Neuromorphic computing	2.8	3.4	1.1	2.4	4.5
NeuroAI algorithms	3.2	3.2	1.2	2.8	3.5
Neuromodulation	3.7	3.3	4.0	2.9	n/a
Digital psychiatry & neurology	2.8	2.9	3.5	2.5	2.0*



Mean score per trend, 1–5, from documented evidence · ecological: 27 orgs where energy or compute matters · * under 3 scored · 09/24

// 09 · who pays

Before we zoom in: who actually pays

Paying their way

Ceribell $89.1M revenue in 2025, +36%

NeuroPace ~$100M revenue guided for 2026

Medtronic adaptive DBS approved; ~$539M a quarter in neuromodulation

Smart Eye sales +53% on EU rules

Brainomix AI in routine stroke care

g.tec, Noldus decades of self-funded instrument sales

Money raised, then closed or sold

VERSES AI stopped all AI work (Jun 2026)

Rain AI collapsed; OpenAI bought patents (2026)

Kintsugi closed after ~$30M (Feb 2026)

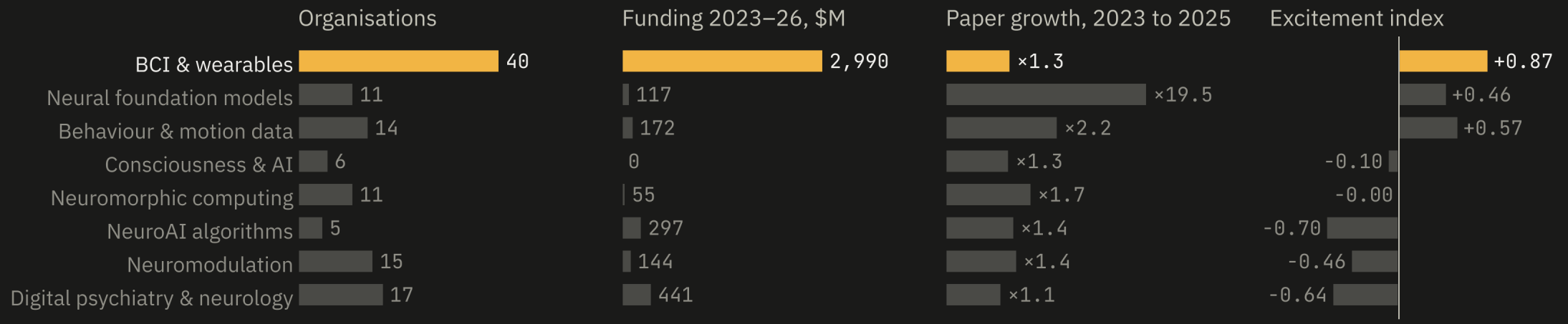
Move AI assets sold for £525k (Oct 2026)

Mindstrong closed after ~$160M (2023)

Neuronetics going-concern doubt; **Tobii** strained liquidity; **MindMaze** rescue financing (2026)

// 10 · zoom 1 of 5

BCI & wearables: the money magnet



Implants race to approval

Neuralink $650M, Synchron $200M, Precision $250M (FDA-cleared for up to 30 days), Science Corp $230M.

Non-surgical bets

Merge Labs ~$250M with OpenAI, Nudge $100M: ultrasound instead of surgery.

China and wearables

Neuracle reports China's first approved implanted BCI. Meta's EMG wristband is on sale.

roles: neural decoding · neural data science · clinical research · neuroengineering · 11/24

// 11 · case study · BCI & wearables

Synchron: a brain implant without open-skull surgery

An electrode array threaded through a blood vessel next to the motor cortex lets people with paralysis control phones and computers.

› $345M raised, including a $200M Series D (Nov 2025)

› First BCI built into Apple’s devices; trains a brain model with NVIDIA

› Next step: the pivotal trial needed for approval

Scores

Longevity	4 / 5
Disruption	5 / 5
Health impact	4 / 5
Economic	2 / 5
Ecological	not scored

For you

Decoding movement intent from neural signals; ML on long, noisy recordings. Title seen: Research Scientist, BCI (New York).

// 12 · zoom 2 of 5

Neural foundation models: research is exploding



Big labs publish openly

Meta FAIR in Paris: an open fMRI model (TRIBE v2); typing decoded from MEG at ~61% of words.

Startups bet on EEG

Hemispheric $52M, Sabi $50M, Piramidal with Cleveland Clinic for intensive-care EEG.

The gap is validation

We found no independent test behind any startup's accuracy claim.

// 13 · case study · neural foundation models

Meta FAIR Brain & AI: industry neuroscience in Paris

A research team building open AI models of how the brain processes language, images and sound.

› TRIBE v2 predicts fMRI responses to video, audio and text, released openly (Mar 2026)

› Brain2Qwerty v2 decodes typed sentences from MEG at ~61% of words (preprint)

› Co-funds an open brain-data project with Fondation Rothschild in Paris

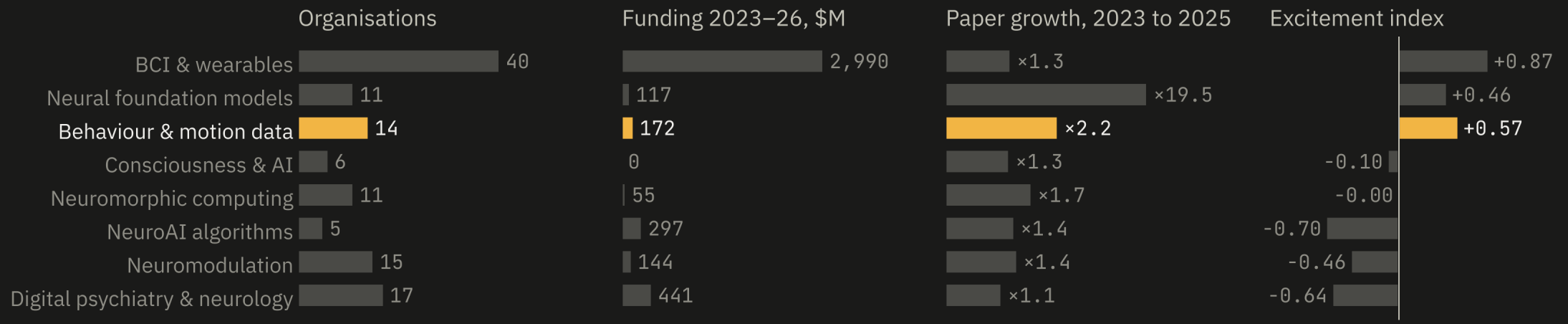
Scores

Longevity	5 / 5
Disruption	4 / 5
Health impact	2 / 5
Economic	5 / 5
Ecological	2 / 5

For you

MEG/fMRI encoding and decoding, deep networks compared with brains. Title seen: Postdoctoral Researcher, Brain & AI (Paris).

Behaviour & motion data: robots are the buyer



Robots buy human motion

People film everyday tasks for robot training: Mecka $60M (Sequoia), Ropedia $22M, Human Archive $8M.

Old models struggle

Move AI sold for £525k; phone-based mood apps Kintsugi and Mindstrong closed.

Rules draw the lines

EU AI Act bans emotion reading at work and school; gait, voice and gaze are barely protected.

// 15 · case study · behaviour & motion data

Mecka: selling human motion to robot makers

Pays people to film everyday tasks from a head-mounted camera; robot companies train on the footage.

› $8M seed (2025), then a $60M Series B led by Sequoia (Oct 2026)

› Part of a wave: Ropedia $22M, Human Archive $8M

› Contrast: Move AI, a motion-capture startup, sold its assets for £525k

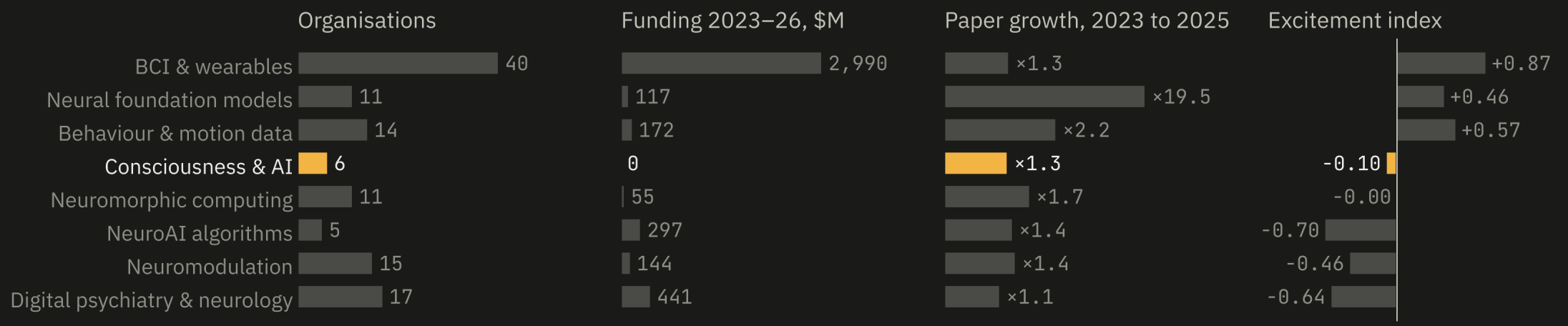
Scores

Longevity	3 / 5
Disruption	4 / 5
Health impact	1 / 5
Economic	4 / 5
Ecological	2 / 5

For you

Behavioural experiment design, data quality, models of pose and video. Title seen: Research Scientist (Toronto).

Consciousness & AI: philanthropy, not venture



No venture money

Funding is philanthropic: Astera Neuro has $600M+ over ten years.

Labs and non-profits

Anthropic's model-welfare team, Eleos AI, PRISM in the UK.

The clinic is concrete

Intrinsic Powers: a bedside test for hidden consciousness. VERSES stopped its AI work.

// 17 · case study · consciousness & AI

Intrinsic Powers: measuring consciousness at the bedside

Founded by Christof Koch, Marcello Massimini and Giulio Tononi: a TMS-EEG test to detect hidden consciousness in unresponsive patients.

› Runs on a $0.5M NIH seed grant

› Struggles to attract venture investors despite a large clinical need

› Contrast: VERSES, built on active inference, stopped all AI work (Jun 2026)

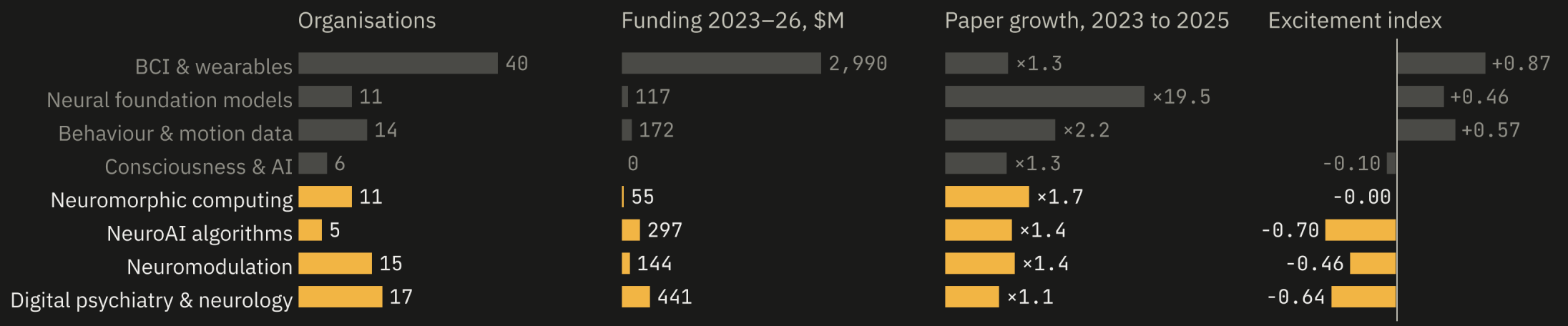
Scores

Longevity	2 / 5
Disruption	4 / 5
Health impact	4 / 5
Economic	1 / 5
Ecological	not scored

For you

EEG and TMS signal analysis, clinical neurophysiology, theory. Most paid roles in this field sit in non-profits such as Astera Neuro or Eleos AI.

The quiet four: where most of the revenue is



Neuromodulation

Medtronic's adaptive deep brain stimulation and Flow's home headset for depression are approved.

Digital psychiatry

Ceribell's EEG with AI made $89M in 2025. Alto's EEG-biomarker trial missed.

Neuromorphic

Chips are in production but cash is thin; Rain AI collapsed.

NeuroAI

Liquid AI ($288M) now sells efficient AI models; VERSES stopped.

ONWARD Medical: from an EPFL lab to revenue

Spinal-cord stimulation that restores arm, hand and leg movement after spinal cord injury.

› External system cleared and selling: €2.0M revenue in Q1 2026, 100+ clinics

› Implant in a pivotal trial; €40M+ raised in 2026, cash into 2028

› Listed on Euronext; built on EPFL / NeuroRestore research

Scores

Longevity	4 / 5
Disruption	4 / 5
Health impact	4 / 5
Economic	3 / 5
Ecological	not scored

For you

Clinical and translational science, closed-loop signal processing, regulated data. European and close to academia.

Europe: strong spin-offs, small cheques

46

organisations in 11 countries; UK 12, Switzerland 7, France 6, Germany 5

17 / 24

of the spin-offs mapped are European

$0.27B

disclosed startup funding 2023–26, against $3.38B in North America

Where	Who and what
Lausanne · Eindhoven	ONWARD (EPFL): spinal stimulation with product revenue
Barcelona	INBRAIN: graphene interfaces, Microsoft partnership
Milan · Genoa	Newronika: adaptive DBS · Corticale (IIT): dense CMOS probes
Paris	Meta FAIR Brain & AI: open MEG/fMRI models · Prophesee
Marseille	VB-Tech: Virtual Brain digital twins for epilepsy surgery
Nottingham · Grenoble	Cerca, Mag4Health: wearable OPM-MEG
Dresden · Zurich	SpiNNcloud (€10M EIC), SynSense: neuromorphic
Cottbus	Zander Labs: passive BCI, ~€30M defence contract

// 21 · the jobs

Job titles seen this month

Organisation	Title seen (Oct 2026)
Meta Reality Labs	Research Scientist, Neural Interfaces (PhD)
Meta FAIR, Paris	Postdoctoral Researcher, Brain & AI
Precision	Staff Neuroscientist · Clinical Data Scientist
Synchron	Research Scientist, BCI
Axoft	Neural Data Scientist
Astera Neuro	Research Scientist, Computational Neuroscience
Alljoined	Computational Neuroscientist
Cortical Labs	Staff/Principal Scientist (Neuroscience)
Ceribell	Data Scientist · Clinical Researcher

Role families across the map

~4 in 5 organisations have research-scientist and ML-engineer roles

~3 in 5 need neural data scientists

~1 in 2 need clinical or translational scientists

Inferred from company profiles, not counted postings

Titles indexed by job-board search, 15 Oct 2026, not confirmed live: check each careers page · 22/24

Five things to take home

01 The money is in BCI; the revenue is in the clinic.

02 Neural foundation models are the closest match to our training, and validation is the scarce skill.

03 Know who pays: robotics buys behaviour data; philanthropy funds consciousness research.

04 Two in three startups and spin-offs have no proven business

05 PIs: open code and data, industry co-supervision, room for production work collaboration, more?

// 23 · keep watching

This snapshot becomes a monthly tracker

```
$ scripts/run_and_push.sh
→ collects Y Combinator · Hacker News · PubMed · ClinicalTrials.gov · FDA · 6 news feeds
→ keyword filter, then Claude reads and tags each item by trend
→ report.md: new companies, rounds, trials and papers since last week
→ re-runs the temperature index and the figures in this deck
```

Questions?

// backup · one worked example

Mapping one profile: MEG, RSA, models of the brain

Skill	Where it transfers	Examples
MEG/EEG decoding	brain foundation models, non-invasive BCI	Meta FAIR, Piramidal, Alljoined
RSA, model–brain comparison	evaluating and validating neural models	Hemispheric, Astera Neuro
Speech and semantics	speech BCIs, language decoding	Paradromics, Echo, Precision
MEG acquisition	wearable OPM-MEG and MEG hardware	Cerca, Mag4Health, MEGIN

Gaps to close, whatever your profile

production-quality code and ML operations · regulated data (FDA design controls, ISO 13485, GDPR) · working with clinical partners · knowing who pays